SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-81804(AS)
14 December 1970

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, IMPULSE, MARK 124 MOD 0

This specification is approved for use within the Naval Air Systems Command, Department of the Navy, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for the manufacture and acceptance of the Mark 124 Mod 0 Impulse Cartridge (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

Military

MIL-P-116	Preservation-Packaging, Methods of
MIL-D-21625	Design and Evaluation of Cartridges for Cartridge Actuated Devices
MIL-C-81803	Ignition Element, Electric, Mark 14 Mod 0
MIL-D-81303	Design and Evaluation of Cartridges for Stores Suspension Equipment.

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-453	Inspection, Radiographic

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions , deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commanding Officer, Naval Air Engineering Center, Systems Engineering and Standardization Department (SESD) Code 93, Lakehurst, NJ 08733, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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2.1.2 Drawings and publications. The following drawings and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

Naval Air Systems Command (Code Ident 30003)

DL 2520046	Ignition Element, Electrical, Mark 14 Mod 0
DL 2838195	Cartridge, Impulse, Mark 124 Mod 0
DL 2838208	Cartridge, Impulse, Mark 124 Mod 0, Packaging Assembly
DL 2838209	Container, Inner, Assembly
DL 844AS820	Test Fixture

PUBLICATIONS

Naval Sea Systems Command (Code Ident 53711)

OP 5	Ammunition and Explosives Ashore
WR-43	Preparation of Quality Assurance Provisions

Code of Federal Regulations

49 CFR 100-199	Transportation

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity).

2.2 Order of Precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards), the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4 and 6.3).

3.2 Conformance to documents. The Mark 124 Mod 0 impulse cartridge covered by this specification shall be manufactured in accordance with DL 2838195 and all documents listed thereon.

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3.3 Materials. All materials used in the manufacture of the cartridges shall conform strictly to the specifications referred to on the respective drawings. When alternate materials or methods of manufacture are specified on the drawings, the bidder's selections shall be clearly stated in the proposal.

3.4 Primary components. For the purposes of this specification the main propellant charge Dwg. 2838195 and the Mark 14 Mod 0 electric ignition element (Dwg. 2520046) are defined as primary components.

3.5 Ignition element. The ignition elements shall be furnished from lots which were manufactured within the past 12 months. The ignition elements shall be manufactured in accordance with the drawings listed on DL 2520046, and shall be from lots which were accepted in accordance with the requirements of MIL-C-81803 (see 4.6.1). When the same contractor manufactures the Mark 14 Mod 0 electric ignition element and the Mark 124 Mod 0 impulse cartridge and assembles the ignition element in the cartridge, the preproduction and production test requirements of MIL-C-81803 for the ignition element shall be waived. Ignition elements shall be free of the defects listed in 4.6.1.

3.6 Propellant charge.

3.6.1 Quantity. All propellant charges shall be as specified on Drawing 2838195 of DL 2838195. Charges shall be determined by weight rather than by volume measurement.

3.6.2 Smokeless powder, handling, and loading. The smokeless powder shall be subjected to no unnecessary handling or exposure to the atmosphere. The handling and loading of smokeless powder exposed to the atmosphere shall be performed only under conditions that do not permit the relative humidity to exceed 75 percent.

3.6.3 Smokeless powder, condition. The smokeless powder used shall exhibit no evidence of decomposition (see 4.6.2)

3.7 Cartridge requirements.

3.7.1 Bridge circuit resistance. The resistance of the bridge circuit in each completely assembled cartridge, when measured electrically (see 4.6.4), shall be not less than 1.00 ohm nor more than 1.20 ohm.

3.7.2 X-ray. Cartridges shall be free of imperfections when X-rayed (see 4.6.6).

3.7.3 Leakage. Cartridge leakage rate shall be not greater than 10^{-5} cubic centimeters of air per second (see 4.6.7).

3.8 Ballistic requirements. Cartridges shall meet the ballistic requirements specified in 3.8.1 through 3.8.3 when subjected to the test prescribed in 4.6.9.

3.8.1 Velocity. The lower limit (L) of velocity shall be 18 ft/sec.

3.8.2 Misfire. There shall be no misfires (see 4.6.9.2).

3.8.3 Hangfire. There shall be no hangfires (see 4.6.9.3).

3.8.4 No-fire. Each of the twenty cartridges set aside for integrity testing shall first meet the no-fire requirements of 4.6.8.

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3.8.5 Cartridge integrity. Twenty cartridges from each first article sample and production lot shall be subjected to the test of 4.6.5. There shall be no propellant gas leakage as described in 4.6.5.1.

3.9 Change in propellant lot. Whenever a change occurs in the propellant lot for the main charge, test firings shall be conducted in accordance with 4.8. No cartridge shall produce results outside the velocity limit of 3.8.1 and no cartridge shall fail to meet the requirements of 3.8.2 and 3.8.3.

3.10 Workmanship. Cartridges shall be free of the following defects: burrs, dents, deep scratches, split or cracked crimp, defective sealant application around the crimp, chipped surfaces, or other defects which may prevent entry of the cartridge into the firing chamber, or affect the stability or resistance of the cartridge to moisture.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4)
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.3 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), all inspections shall be performed as specified in the applicable test method of 4.6.

4.4 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed after award of contract and prior to production by a facility designated in the contract or order (see 6.2). A first article sample acceptable for environmental and function testing shall be considered as a sample that has met the requirements of 3.2 through 3.7.3 and 3.10 of this specification. First article inspection shall be performed on sample units which have been produced using the same materials, equipment, processes and procedures as will be used in regular production. All parts and materials, including packaging and packing shall be the same as used for regular production and shall be from the intended sources of supply.

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4.4.1 Sample size. The first article sample shall consist of 192 cartridges.

4.4.2 Inspection routine. One hundred and eighty-two cartridges shall be expended in the tests listed below and 10 shall be retained for investigative purposes. A first article sample acceptable for environmental and functional testing shall be defined as a sample which has met the requirements of 3.1-3.7.3 and 3.10 of this specification. First article sample acceptance shall consist of the twenty integrity cartridges being tested first according to the no-fire test of 4.6.8, succeeded by the following tests as prescribed in Table 3 of MIL-D-81303; except for temperature and humidity cycling which shall be in accordance with Table 3 of MIL-D-21625: temperature and humidity cycling (18); vibration (12); 15 "g" shock (12); 40-foot drop (6); +70°F (12); −65°F (12); +200°F (12). Tolerance on temperatures shall be ±5°F. Temperature conditioning prior to firing shall be for a minimum period of six hours. The numbers in the parentheses denote the number of firings allocated for test, using two cartridges for each firing, except for the 40-foot drop which is a non-firing test. The above cartridge firings shall be conducted in a Aero 7A ejector rack as specified in 4.6.9. No cartridge shall produce results outside the velocity limit of 4.8.1 and no cartridge shall fail to meet the requirements of 3.8.2, 3.8.3 and 3.8.5. Of the remaining cartridges, 20 shall be subjected to the cartridge integrity test of 4.6.5. The failure of any cartridge to meet the requirements as stated above shall cause rejection of the first article sample.

4.4.3 Failure. Failure of any cartridge shall be cause for rejection of the first article sample.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall consist of the tests specified in table I.

TABLE I. Quality conformance tests and examinations.

Item	Nature of test	Requirement paragraph	Test paragraph	Classification (WR-43)
Primary component	Single lot verification	3.4	4.5.1	(M101)
Ignition element	Age and acceptance verification	3.5	4.6.1	(C1)
Ignition element	X-ray	3.5	4.6.1	(C2)
Propellant charge	Type and weight	3.6.1	—	(C3)
Smokless powder	Condition	3.6.3	4.6.2	(C4)
Cartridge	Visual examination	3.10	4.6.3	(M102)
Cartridge	Bridge circuit resistance	3.7.1	4.6.4	(C5)
Cartridge	X-ray	3.7.2	4.6.6	(C6)
Cartridge	Leakage	3.7.3	4.6.7	(C7)
Cartridge	No-fire	3.8.4	4.6.8	(C8)
Cartridge	Ballistics	3.8	4.6.9	(C9)
Cartridge	Propellant gas leakage	3.8.6	4.6.5.1	(M103)
Cartridge	Integrity	3.8.5	4.6.5	(M104)
Cartridge	Ballistics (change in propellant lot)	3.9	4.8	(C10)
Cartridge	Preservation-packaging, packing and marking	Section 5	4.6.3	(M105)

4.5.1 Lot size. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the production lot size shall be 5000 minimum. Cartridges required for all test purposes shall be selected from the production lot and shall not be applied as part of the quantity specified for delivery by the contract. Only primary components from a single lot shall be used in a production lot of cartridges. One primary component production lot may be used in more than one cartridge production lot. Cartridges selected for ballistic tests shall be delivered to the designated contracting agency.

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4.5.2 Sampling. A sample of cartridges for the ballistic test shall be selected from each production lot in accordance with table II, except that a double sample shall be required since two cartridges are used in each firing. In addition to the sample of cartridges for the ballistic test, 30 additional cartridges shall be furnished from each production lot. Of these cartridges, 20 shall be fired in the cartridge integrity test of 4.6.5 and 10 shall be retained for investigative purposes.

TABLE II. Quality conformance sample size.

Lot size	Sample size	Retained sample	Integrity test samples
66-110	15	10	20
111-180	15	10	20
181-300	20	10	20
301-500	25	10	20
501-800	30	10	20
801-1300	35	10	20
1301-3200	40	10	20
3201-8000	50	10	20
8001-22000	75	10	20

4.5.3 Classification of characteristics. The characteristics verified by the tests and examinations herein are classified as critical, major, or minor in accordance with WR-43. Tests and examinations that verify critical characteristics are identified by the symbol (C) and major characteristics by the symbol (M). The number following the classification symbol indicates the serial number of the test or examination. Tests and examinations which are not annotated with a classification code are classified minor.

4.6 Tests.

4.6.1 Ignition element X-ray. Each ignition element, prior to insertion in the cartridge, shall be mounted in suitable racks or frames and oriented so that the most revealing exposure can be obtained. Pressure sensitive tape may be used as an aid in positioning the ignition element. Reject all elements that have any questionable qualities such as: improperly assembled, deformed or missing igniter assembly; electrode washer; ignition element cup; loaded spacer; and closing disc or abnormally thin or missing loaded spacer charge.

4.6.2 Smokeless powder, condition. Smokeless powder shall be inspected in accordance with the applicable paragraphs of OP 5. Evidence of decomposition shall be cause for rejection.

4.6.3 Visual examination. All cartridges shall be visually examined. Cartridges having any of the defects of 3.10 shall be cause for rejection. The preservation-packaging, packing, and marking of the cartridges shall be examined for conformance to section 5.

4.6.4 Bridge circuit resistance. Conformance with the bridge circuit resistance of 3.7.1 shall be ascertained on all completely assembled cartridges by means of a test circuit which limits the bridge circuit current to not greater than 25 milliamperes. A safety chamber with an interlock switch shall be used to protect the operator during the application of current. A suitable instrument which is known to be accurate to within 1 percent in the range of resistance specified shall be used to determine whether or not the requirement is being met. Units which fail to meet the requirements of 3.7.1 shall be cause for rejection. The results of bridge circuit resistance measurements shall not be affected by resistance of the test circuit and connector.

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4.6.5 Cartridge integrity test. A sample of 20 cartridges from each production lot and 20 cartridges from the first article sample shall fired to test the ability of the cartridges to contain the propellant gases. After having met the no-fire requirements of 3.8A the cartridges shall be conditioned at 70° ± 5°F for a minimum period of 6 hours and fired in a closed test chamber. The test chamber (DL 844AS820) shall have an internal volume, with a fixed cartridge in place, of 5.00 ± 0.05 cubic inches, and the capability of withstanding an internal pressure of 30,500 pounds per square inch, minimum.

4.6.5.1 Criteria of acceptability. After firing, the ignition element end of each cartridge of the first article sample and each cartridge of the production lot ballistic and cartridge integrity samples shall be examined for evidence of propellant gas leakage through or around the ignition element. If one or more of the first article sample exhibit evidence of propellant gas leakage or fail to fire, this shall be cause for rejection of the first article sample. If one or more cartridges of the production lot samples (ballistic or cartridge integrity) exhibit evidence of propellant gas leakage or fail to fire, this shall be cause for rejection of the production lot.

4.6.6 Radiographic examination. All cartridges, in the first article and production test samples, shall be radiographically examined in accordance with MIL-STD-453. Cartridges having any observable imperfections in assembly shall be cause for rejection. The cartridges shall be positioned on their sides for the most revealing exposure. All cartridges shall be identified with serial numbers prior to examination. The cartridge serial numbers shall be in consecutive order beginning with the number 001 in each production lot. The cartridges shall be arranged on trays or boards in consecutive numerical order, and each radiograph shall carry a permanent identification of the cartridges displayed thereon. The radiograph identification shall include the complete lot number, as stamped on the cartridges, and the span of serial numbers displayed. If any assembly or loading defects are noted in the production lot samples, the contractor shall X-ray the represented lot 100 percent and make available the X-rays to the cartridge design activity for review. Discontinuities in serial numbers shall be identified on the X-ray. Defective cartridges found by the vendor shall be clearly identified on the X-ray and those defectives removed from the production lot. The serial numbers shall be pen or ink stamped on the cartridges with approximately 1/8-inch-high characters. The serial numbers shall be located apart from the other cartridge markings.

4.6.7 Leakage. Each cartridge in the first article or production sample shall be leak tested in a dry gas leak tester. Cartridges which exhibit a leak rate greater than 10^{-5} cc per second of air at a pressure differential of 1 ± 0.1 atmosphere shall be considered defective. Cartridges of the first article sample which exhibit a leakage defect shall be cause for rejection. If the number of cartridges of the production lot sample exhibiting leak defects exceeds an AQL of 2.5 percent defective from table II-A of MIL-STD-105, then a 100 percent leak test of the lot being tested shall be required. Cartridges which exhibit a leak rate greater than that specified above shall be cause for rejection (see 6.5).

4.6.8 No-fire test. Each of the twenty cartridge integrity samples shall first be subjected to no-fire testing prior to integrity testing. Samples shall be conditioned for a minimum of six hours at +70° ± 5°F prior to testing. A current of 1.0 +0.10, −0.00 ampers, regulated within an accuracy of one percent, shall be applied to each cartridge for a period of 5 +0.1, −0.0 minutes. Any cartridge which fires shall be considered defective and shall cause rejection of the lot or sample represented. During this test, ensure that the cartridge is sufficiently shielded to prevent personnel injury or material damage in the event a cartridge fires.

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4.6.9 Ballistic tests. The number of cartridges selected from each production lot for the ballistic test shall be in accordance with table II. The cartridges shall be conditioned for not less than 12 hours at 70° ± 5°F and fired in an Aero 7A ejector rack, mounted horizontally, ejecting a 1000-pound inert store. The firing current shall be 10.0 ± 0.2 amperes, applied through a parallel circuit to the two cartridges. Instrumentation shall be provided to measure time from actuation of the firing circuit to first indication of store movement, or rack hook opening, and to measure store velocity for the first 6-inch interval from end of ejector stroke. Acceptance criteria (regardless of lot size) shall be: accept zero defects and reject if one or more defects.

4.6.9.1 Criteria of acceptability. The lower (L) limit of velocity shall meet the requirement of 3.8.1. A failure of any cartridge to meet this requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented.

4.6.9.2 Misfire. The failure of any cartridge to fire shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented, unless such failure is plainly attributable to faulty test equipment or procedure.

4.6.9.3 Hangfire. One or more hangfires (see 6.4.5) shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented.

4.6.9.4 Propellant gas leakage. Evidence of propellant gas leakage by one or more cartridges when examined in accordance with 4.6.5.1, shall cause rejection of the lot represented.

4.7 Retest. There shall be no retests.

4.7.1 Test failure. If test failure is attributable to an assignable cause, excluding the test cartridge, original test results should be discarded and that portion of the test reconducted.

4.8 Change in propellant lot. Whenever a change in propellant lot for the main charge occurs, the charge weight shall be verified by firing 36 cartridges which have been temperature conditioned as follows: 12 at −65° ± 5°F, 12 at 70° ± 5°F, and 12 at 200° ± 5°F. Results of the test firings shall meet the requirements of 3.9.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation and packaging. For definitions of packaging levels, see 6.4.

5.1.1 Level A. Level A packaging shall be used for packaging of all production lots for service use. Forty cartridges shall be packaged in an inner container in accordance with Dwg. 2838209.

5.1.2 Level B. Not applicable.

5.1.3 Level C. When specified in the contract, those cartridges which are intended for expenditure in first article sample testing and production lot acceptance testing shall be packaged in accordance with method III of MIL-P-116 and with 49 CFR 171-178.

5.2 Packing. For definitions of packing levels, see 6.4.

5.2.1 Level A. Level A packing shall be used for packing of all production lots for service use. Eight inner containers as described in 5.1.1 shall be packed in accordance with Dwg. 2838208.

5.2.2 Level B. Not applicable.

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5.2.3 Level C. When directed by the procuring activity, cartridges intended for expenditure in first article testing and for production lot acceptance tests and are packaged in accordance with 5.1.3 shall be packed to afford protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use. Shipping containers shall be in accordance with 49 CFR 171-178.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Special marking. Marking of exterior containers shall be in accordance with 49 CFR 171-178.

5.3.2 Normal marking. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the marking information on unit packages and shipping containers shall be as specified on Dwg. 2838209 and Dwg. 2838208, respectively. The specified marking information shall be applied to the containers in accordance with the applicable provisions of MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The Mark 124 Mod 0 impulse cartridge is used as the power source in Stores Release/Ejection mechanism on aircraft.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification
b. Whether first article inspection is required, and if so, specify the test activity
c. Date and place of delivery
d. Inspection conditions, if other than as specified (see 4.3)
e. That revision "D" of MIL-D-21625 and revision "A" of MIL-D-81303 be used (see 4.4.2)
f. Lot size, if other than as specified (see 4.5.1)
g. Special marking, if any (see 5.3)
h. That the safety precaution requirements of the "Contractor's Safety Manual for Ammunition, Explosives, and Related Dangerous Material," DoD 4145.26M are applicable. NOTE: When this specification is used as part of the description of work to be accomplished by a Government activity, the safety precaution requirements of "Ammunition and Explosives Ashore," OP5 are applicable.

6.3 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the item should be a first article sample. The first article should consist of 192 cartridges. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, approval of first article test results and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirements for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or test, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

6.4 Definitions. For the purpose of this specification, the following definitions apply.

6.4.1 Level A packaging. The degree of preservation-packaging which will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration and physical damage during handling, shipment, indeterminate storage and world-wide redistribution.

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6.4.2 Level C packaging. The degree of preservation-packaging which will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration and physical damage during shipment from supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use. This level may conform to the supplier's commercial practice when such meets the requirements of this level.

6.4.3 Level A packing. The degree of packing which will afford adequate protection during shipment, handling, indeterminate storage and world-wide redistribution.

6.4.4 Level C packing. The degree of packing which will afford protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use. This level in general will conform to applicable carrier rules and regulations and may be the supplier's commercial practice when such meets the requirements of this level.

6.4.5 Hangfire. A hangfire is defined as a firing in which the elapsed time between actuation of the firing mechanism and first store movement or hook opening exceeds 0.025 second.

6.5 Advisory leak test. Indian Head leak tests cartridges in accordance with "Cartridge Leak Test Procedures at the Naval Ordnance Station, Indian Head, Md."

6.6 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks (or vertical lines) are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

6.7 Subject term (key word) listing.
Cartridge, impulse
Stores Release/Ejection mechanism, aircraft
Smokeless powder
Propellant Charge
Hangfire

Preparing activity
Navy-AS
(Project 1377-N915)

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NOTE: This form m•y not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
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